Anjali Nair

Curriculum Vitae

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Research Profile

Early career researcher with a PhD in Linguistics and experience in theoretical research and applied work across education and development policy contexts. Experience includes multilingual education, collaborative language documentation, qualitative fieldwork, and research communication for academic, policy, and practitioner audiences.

Research interests: Dravidian and South Asian languages; Indian English; Language Bias; Morphological Theory; Language education and Language Policy; Sociolinguistics; Language Documentation

Education

2024 **PhD, Linguistics**
Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi
Thesis: *Roots in Malayalam*
Advisor: Prof. Ayesha Kidwai

2018 **MPhil, Linguistics**
Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi
Thesis: *Temporal Inflections in Malayalam Verbs*
Advisor: Prof. Ayesha Kidwai

2016 **MA, Linguistics**
Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi

2014 **BA, English**
Women's Christian College, University of Madras, Chennai

Publications

Monograph

2026 *A Grammar of Gaddi*. London: UCL Press. Co-authored monograph developed through collaborative language documentation.

Journal Articles

2023 "Malayalam tense morphology: A reanalysis using a DM lens." *Language in India* 23(11).

Book Chapters

2020 "Binary tense in Malayalam: A synchronic analysis." In *Queries in the Structure of Language* (edited volume).

Research Experience

July 2026 – Present

Research Consultant
Language and Learning Foundation | Fieldwork in Bastar, Chhattisgarh, India

- Conducted qualitative fieldwork in Bastar, a multilingual region of central India where tribal languages Halbi, Bhatri and Gondi are spoken alongside the state language of instruction.
- Designed the conceptual framework and overall research design for a qualitative study of language bias among teachers in early-grade classrooms.
- Conducted classroom observation, interviews, reflective discussions with teachers and the collection of classroom artefacts.
- Carried out thematic and cross-case analysis of field evidence across sites and language settings.
- Prepared publication-quality research outputs, including the full manuscript, an executive summary, a policy brief and a methodological note.

Teaching Experience

2020 **Instructor |** *Introductory Morphology* (undergraduate elective)
Jawaharlal Nehru University
Designed the curriculum and delivered the course through interactive, discussion-based teaching; responsible for assessment and evaluation.

2020 **Teaching Assistant |** *Grammatical Categories* (postgraduate core course)
Jawaharlal Nehru University, with Prof. Ayesha Kidwai
Led tutorials and evaluated group work, assignments and end-of-semester examinations.

Invited and Guest Lectures

2016 "Wonders of Language." Introductory talk to approximately 45 school students on the study of language and the structure of the human mind.

2016 "Introduction to Linguistics." Talk to approximately 50 students on the discipline and its applications.

Conference Presentations

2020 "A tense matter: The Malayalam morphology of tense." *1st Zoomdemic*, all-India virtual linguistics webinar series for research scholars, Jawaharlal Nehru University.

2019 "Malayalam tense morphology: A reanalysis using a DM lens." *9th Formal Approaches to South Asian Languages* (FASAL).

2018 "Binary tense in Malayalam: A synchronic analysis." *40th International Conference of the Linguistic Society of India* (ICOLSI).

2018 "Past tense in Malayalam: A case in morpho-phonemic theory." *56th All India Conference of Dravidian Linguists* (AICDL), Kolkata.

2015 "Phonological distribution of the Malayalam dative case." *37th International Conference of the Linguistic Society of India* (ICOLSI). Co-authored.

Professional Service and Public Engagement

2025 April–Present

Learning Facilitator
Pagdandi Collective

- Founding member of a youth education collective that organises rural immersion and experiential learning programmes on decolonial knowledge systems.
- Facilitated group discussions, lecture series, public talks and cultural gatherings in coordination with senior academic faculty, scholars and artists to promote cross-institutional dialogue on cultural issues.
- Strengthened the collective's public and academic visibility through curated content, long-form writing and strategic digital outreach, engaging both scholarly and general intellectual audiences.

2022 September – April 2025

Communications Consultant
Global Health Strategies

- Built and secured partnerships with academics, scientists and institutional actors across India, Africa and Southeast Asia.
- Led the development of long-form research outputs, including white papers, conference abstracts, feasibility studies and synthesis reports, working closely with subject-matter experts and researchers.
- Managed high-stakes review processes for sensitive manuscripts, incorporating feedback from senior experts, donors and government stakeholders.
- Conducted soft-skills workshops for OB/GYNs and paramedics on sensitive patient-care communication, strengthening clinician-patient rapport in high-stakes reproductive and maternal health settings.
- Designed messaging strategies and advocacy campaigns to drive social and behaviour change, translating complex public health evidence into targeted communication for diverse clinical, community and policy audiences.

Additional Academic Training

2019 — *Introduction to Scientific Theory Construction through Language Structure.* Winter School, University of Mumbai. Instructors: Prof. K. P. Mohanan (IISER) and Prof. Tara Mohanan (NUS).

2016 — *Harmonic Grammar: Models and Methods.* Global Initiative of Academic Networks, IIT Guwahati. Instructors: Prof. Joe Pater (UMass Amherst) and Assoc. Prof. Shakuntala Mahanta (IIT Guwahati).

Qualifications and Certifications

2016 — **National Eligibility Test (NET), Linguistics** — University Grants Commission, India. Scored 73%; certified as qualified to hold an Assistant Professorship in Linguistics.

2016 — **IELTS** — Band 8.0 of 9.0 (listening, reading, speaking, writing).